admirable professional independence which made him a role model for all his successors. Finally, there is H.T. Parekh, the ultimate visionary and institutionbuilder, who not only widened the boundaries of development banks but who is rightly acknowledged as the father of housing finance in the country.

These then are the personalities who adorn the pages of this book. They were innovators, executors and consolidators. They were all men of extraordinary integrity, courage and conviction, and as the pages of this book will show, national interest informed their every action. The Indian banking system which they helped shape has stood the test of time, and the resilience with which it has withstood the challenges posed by several global crises over the last two decades is evidence of its robustness.

This book is as much a tribute to the Indian banking system as it is to the six ‘barons’ who occupy a place of pre-eminence in it.

Yezdi H. Malegam
(Trustee, The A.D. Shroff Memorial Trust, Mumbai)